

Word family: ****live / lives / lived / living / alive / lively / livable / liveable / livelihood****

****Base word:** live**

****Verb forms:** live, lives, lived, living**

****Important related forms/extensions:** alive, living, lively, livable/liveable, livelihood**

****Useful compounds:** live broadcast, live music, live performance, live stream/livestream, live audience, live wire, live ammunition, live issue, live data**

****Essential expression from your passage:** **live up to + expectation/hype/promise****

A full family sweep confirms that ****live is extremely rich**** because it has several major meanings and, importantly, ****the pronunciation changes between the verb and adjective****.

* ****live — verb****: as in *I live in London*

* ****live — adjective****: as in *live music*

So this is excellent polysemy material.

Your sentence:

> “A few weeks later, I bought the headphones, and they really ****lived up to the hype****.”

Because ****live up to**** is essential to your original sentence, we should include it even though we normally exclude phrasal verbs by default.

Meaning in your passage

Here:

> ****lived up to the hype****

means:

****performed as well as the advertising, praise, and public excitement had led people to expect.****

****繁體中文:** **實際表現達到了之前宣傳、好評和熱度所建立的高期待;沒有令人失望****

Natural translation:

> “They really lived up to the hype.”

「它們的表現真的****不負之前的好評和高期待****。」

So here, ****live**** does ****not**** mean 「居住」 or 「活著」.

The whole expression means:

****live up to + expectation/reputation/hype = 達到某種期待、標準或名聲所要求的水平****

1. ****live in/at + place(住所／地方) — 居住; 住在.....****

This is one of the central verb meanings.

Practice 1

> “She ****lives in**** London.”

「她****住在倫敦****。」

Practice 2

> “I used to ****live**** near the station.”

「我以前****住在車站附近****。」

****live + place = 把某個地方作為日常生活和居住的地方****

Compare with ****stay****:

* live somewhere → 長期／固定居住

* stay somewhere → 暫時逗留

2. ****live = be alive / continue to exist(人／動物／生物) — 活著; 生存****

****Meaning:** To be alive rather than dead.**

Practice 3

> “Some turtles can ****live**** for more than a hundred years.”

「有些海龜可以****活超過一百年****。」

Practice 4

> “The doctors did everything they could to help him ****live****.”

「醫生盡了一切努力幫助他****活下去****。」

****live** = 生物保持生命、繼續生存而沒有死亡******

3. ****live for + period / live to + age**(壽命) — 活.....之久; 活到.....歲******

Practice 5

> “The animal can ****live for**** twenty years.”

「這種動物可以****活二十年****。」

Practice 6

> “Her grandmother ****lived to**** the age of ninety-eight.”

「她的祖母****活到九十八歲****。」

****live for + period** = 生存某段時間******

****live to + age** = 活到某個年齡******

This belongs to the biological-survival meaning.

4. ****live + type of life**(生活方式／人生) — 過.....生活; 度過.....人生******

****Meaning:**** To experience or lead a particular kind of life.

Practice 7

> “She wants to ****live a peaceful life****.”

「她希望****過平靜的生活****。」

Practice 8

> “They ****lived a simple life**** in the countryside.”

「他們在鄉郊****過著簡樸的生活****。」

****live a + type of life = 以某種方式生活、過某種人生****

Here ****live**** means more than simply “be alive”; it describes ****how one conducts one’s life****.

5. ****live + dream/life/experience (理想／人生／經歷) — 親身實現; 真正經歷****

A figurative extension.

Practice 9

> “She is finally ****living her dream****.”

「她終於正在****實現並過著自己夢想中的生活****。」

Practice 10

> “He wanted to ****live life**** on his own terms.”

「他希望按照自己的方式****過自己的人生****。」

****live something = 親身經歷、實踐或真正過出某種人生／理想****

6. ****live up to + expectation/reputation/hype (期待／名聲／宣傳) — 達到; 不負……****

This is ****your original construction****.

****Meaning:**** To perform or behave at the level that people expected because of a reputation, promise, description, or publicity.

Practice 11 — Original

> “The headphones really ****lived up to the hype****.”

「這副耳機的實際表現真的****不負之前的熱度和高期待****。」

Practice 12

> “The hotel ****lived up to our expectations****.”

「這間酒店的表現**達到了我們的期待**。」

Practice 13

> “The film didn’t **live up to its reputation**.”

「這部電影的實際表現**配不上它原有的名聲／沒有達到大家的期待**。」

****live up to something = 實際表現達到某個期待、標準、承諾或名聲所建立的水平****

Common objects:

* live up to ****expectations****

* live up to ****the hype****

* live up to ****a reputation****

* live up to ****a promise****

* live up to ****a standard****

7. ****live = survive/support yourself in a particular way(維持生活) — 維生; 過活****

The idea is being able to continue one's life.

Practice 14

> “It is difficult to ****live**** on such a small income.”

「靠這麼少的收入很難****維持生活****。」

Practice 15

> “For years, he ****lived**** very cheaply.”

「多年來, 他一直以非常節省的方式****過活****。」

****live = 以某些資源或生活條件維持日常生存****

I won't expand the phrasal constructions here beyond what is necessary, but this broader “maintain one's life” sense is useful.

8. ****live = remain in people's memory/culture(記憶／文化／傳統) — 繼續存在; 流傳****

A useful figurative meaning.

Practice 16

> “Her music continues to **live** through new generations.”

「她的音樂透過新一代繼續**流傳／延續下去**。」

Practice 17

> “The tradition still **lives** in the local community.”

「這個傳統仍然在當地社群中**延續存在**。」

live — figurative = 某種思想、傳統、作品或記憶雖非生物，仍繼續存在或產生影響

9. **live** = happening/broadcast at the same time (節目／廣播) — 現場直播的; 即時播出的

Now **live** is an adjective, and **the pronunciation changes**.

Meaning: Broadcast at the same time the event is actually happening rather than recorded earlier.

Practice 18

> “The match will be shown **live** on television.”

「這場比賽將在電視上**現場直播**。」

Practice 19

> “We watched the **live broadcast**.”

「我們觀看了**現場直播**。」

live — broadcast = 事件發生的同時立即向觀眾播放，而不是預先錄製的

10. **live** = performance happening in person (音樂／表演) — 現場的; 真人即場演出的

Practice 20

> “I prefer **live music** to recordings.”

「比起錄音，我更喜歡**現場音樂**。」

Practice 21

> “The café has **live performances** every weekend.”

「這間咖啡店每個週末都有**現場表演**。」

live performance/music = 演出者在觀眾面前即場表演，而非播放預先錄製內容

This belongs to the same “happening now/in person” adjective concept.

11. **live** = audience physically present (觀眾) — 現場的

Practice 22

> “The programme was recorded in front of a **live audience**.”

「節目在**現場觀眾**面前錄製。」

Practice 23

> “Speaking to a **live audience** feels different from recording a video.”

「對著**現場觀眾**說話和錄製影片的感覺很不同。」

live audience = 真正在現場觀看／參與的人，而不是遠端或錄製內容的觀眾

12. **live** = currently active/operating (系統／網站／服務) — 已啟用的；正式運作中的

A very useful technology/business meaning.

Practice 24

> “The new website is now **live**.”

「新網站現在已經**正式上線／啟用**。」

Practice 25

> “The payment system will go **live** tomorrow.”

「付款系統明天將**正式啟用**。」

live — system/service = 已經正式啟用並可供真實使用者使用的

This is extremely common in technology and business.

13. **live** = current/real rather than test data (資料／系統) — 即時的; 真實運作中的

Practice 26

> “The dashboard displays **live data**.”

「儀表板顯示**即時數據**。」

Practice 27

> “Do not test the feature using the **live database**.”

「不要在**正式運作中的真實資料庫**測試這項功能。」

live data/system = 來自當前真實運作環境, 而不是示範、測試或靜態資料的

14. **live** = electrically active (電線／電路) — 帶電的; 通電的

A major safety meaning.

Practice 28

> “Do not touch a **live wire**.”

「不要觸摸**帶電電線**。」

Practice 29

> “The electrician checked whether the cable was still **live**.”

「電工檢查電纜是否仍然**帶電**。」

live — electricity = 正在承載電流, 因此可能造成觸電危險的

This is genuinely distinct and very important.

15. **live = ammunition/explosive actually capable of functioning (彈藥／爆炸物) — 實彈的; 真的有作用的**

Another safety/technical meaning.

Practice 30

> “The training area contained **live ammunition**.”

「訓練區內有**實彈**。」

Practice 31

> “They discovered a **live explosive device**.”

「他們發現了一個**仍具有爆炸能力的爆炸裝置**。」

live ammunition/explosive = 並非假的、訓練用或失效的, 而是真正可發射／爆炸的

16. **live = currently important/unresolved (議題／問題) — 當前仍存在的; 仍在爭論中的**

A useful formal sense.

Practice 32

> “Privacy remains a **live issue**.”

「私隱仍然是一個**當前重要而尚未解決的議題**。」

Practice 33

> “The question is still very much **live**.”

「這個問題目前仍然**存在、尚未定論**。」

****live issue/question = 現時仍具現實重要性、仍在討論或尚未解決的議題****

17. ****live = biologically alive (動物／植物／微生物) — 活的; 有生命的****

The adjective can literally mean ****living rather than dead****.

Practice 34

> “The laboratory works with ****live cells****.”

「實驗室研究****活細胞****。」

Practice 35

> “The snake was transported ****live****.”

「那條蛇以****活體****方式運送。」

****live — biological adjective = 仍然有生命活動、不是死亡或非生命狀態的****

18. ****live = burning/glowing (煤／火) — 仍在燃燒的; 有火的****

A useful established sense.

Practice 36

> “Be careful—there are still ****live coals**** in the fireplace.”

「小心，壁爐裡仍有****正在燃燒／仍有火的煤炭****。」

Practice 37

> “A ****live ember**** landed on the floor.”

「一顆****仍然帶火的餘燼****落在地板上。」

****live coal/ember = 仍然發熱、燃燒或可能再次引起火焰的****

19. **living = being alive (生物) — 活著的; 有生命的**

Practice 38

> “All **living** things need energy.”

「所有**生物／有生命的東西**都需要能量。」

Practice 39

> “The museum studies both extinct and **living** species.”

「博物館研究已滅絕和**現存的**物種。」

living — biological = 目前具有生命的, 而不是死亡或已滅絕的

20. **living = way/state of life (名詞) — 生活; 生活方式**

Practice 40

> “The cost of **living** has increased.”

「**生活成本**上升了。」

Practice 41

> “City **living** can be expensive.”

「城市**生活**可能很昂貴。」

living — noun = 日常生活和維持生活的方式／條件

21. **a living = income needed to support yourself — 生計; 收入**

A very important noun use.

Practice 42

> “She earns a **living** as a designer.”

「她靠做設計師**維持生計**。」

Practice 43

> “It can be difficult to make a **living** from art.”

「單靠藝術**維生／賺取生活費**可能很困難。」

a living = 足以支付日常生活需要的收入／謀生方式

Common:

> **earn a living** = 謀生

> **make a living** = 維持生計

22. **living = currently used/spoken/changing (語言／傳統) — 活的; 仍在使用和發展的**

Practice 44

> “English is a **living language**.”

「英語是一種**仍然有人使用並持續發展的活語言**。」

Practice 45

> “The festival is part of a **living tradition**.”

「這個節日是一種**仍在延續和實踐的傳統**。」

living language/tradition = 並非只存在於歷史, 而是目前仍有人實際使用、實踐並繼續演變的

23. **alive = living / not dead (人／生物) — 活著的; 仍有生命的**

A major related family member.

Practice 46

> “The missing hikers were found **alive**.”

「失蹤的遠足者被發現時仍然**活著**。」

Practice 47

> “Is the plant still **alive**?”

「這株植物仍然**活著嗎**？」

alive = 仍然具有生命, 而不是死亡

Important grammar:

Normally:

> “The animal is alive.” 

Not normally:

> *an alive animal* 

Before a noun, use:

> **a live animal**

This is a crucial contrast.

24. **alive = full of activity/excitement (地方／人) — 充滿活力的; 活躍的**

A figurative extension.

Practice 48

> “The city comes **alive** at night.”

「這座城市晚上變得**充滿活力、非常熱鬧**。」

Practice 49

> “Her face became **alive** with excitement.”

「她的臉因興奮而變得**神采飛揚**。」

****alive — figurative = 充滿活力、活動、情緒或生氣的****

25. ****lively = energetic/active (人／氣氛) — 活潑的; 充滿活力的****

Practice 50

> “They had a ****lively**** discussion.”

「他們進行了一場****熱烈活躍的討論****。」

Practice 51

> “The café has a ****lively**** atmosphere.”

「這間咖啡店的氣氛很****熱鬧、有活力****。」

****lively = 充滿能量、活動、興奮感或熱鬧氣氛的****

26. ****lively = interesting and stimulating (內容／討論) — 生動有趣的; 熱烈的****

Practice 52

> “The speaker gave a ****lively**** presentation.”

「講者作了一場****生動有趣的簡報****。」

Practice 53

> “The article is written in a ****lively**** style.”

「這篇文章的文風****生動活潑****。」

****lively — content/style = 有活力、有趣而能保持別人注意力的****

27. ****livable / liveable = suitable or comfortable enough to live in — 適宜居住的; 可居住的****

Both spellings occur.

Practice 54

> “The apartment is small but **livable**.”

「公寓雖然小，但仍然**適合居住／住得下去**。」

Practice 55

> “Good transport makes a city more **liveable**.”

「良好的交通可以令城市更**宜居**。」

livable/liveable = 生活條件、安全、空間或環境達到可以舒適／合理居住的程度

28. **livelihood** = means of earning enough to live — 生計；謀生方式

An important lexical family extension.

Practice 56

> “Fishing is their main **livelihood**.”

「捕魚是他們主要的**生計來源**。」

Practice 57

> “The closure threatened hundreds of people’s **livelihoods**.”

「關閉事件威脅到數百人的**生計**。」

livelihood = 一個人用來賺取收入、維持生活的工作／經濟來源

Compare:

> **a living** = 謀生所得／生計

> **livelihood** = 謀生方式／生計來源

Important pronunciation distinction: live verb vs live adjective

This is essential.

live — verb

> “I **live** in London.”

= 居住

The vowel is like **give**.

live — adjective

> “a **live** concert”

= 現場的

The vowel is like **five**.

So the spelling is identical, but the pronunciation changes with meaning/part of speech.

This is exactly the kind of polysemy + pronunciation distinction our Golden Manual requires us to flag.

Important distinction: **live vs alive**

live

can come directly before a noun:

> a **live** animal

> live music

> live broadcast

alive

usually comes after **be/remain/stay**, not directly before a noun:

> The animal is **alive**.

Not normally:

> *an alive animal*

Meaning:

* **live animal** = 活的動物

* **animal is alive** = 動物仍然活著

Important distinction: live vs living

For biological meaning:

live

often emphasizes that something is **not dead / is actually active**.

> live fish

living

often describes the broader category of organisms that possess life.

> living organisms

Both can mean 「活的」, but collocation differs.

Important distinction: live vs stay

live

= have your home somewhere.

> “I live in Seattle.”

stay

= remain somewhere temporarily.

> “I’m staying in a hotel.”

So:

> “Where do you live?”

= 你住在哪裡？

> “Where are you staying?”

= 你這段時間住在哪裡？

Important distinction: **live vs survive**

live

= be alive / continue life generally.

survive

= remain alive despite danger, illness, accident, hardship, etc.

> “People can live for many years.”

「人可以活很多年。」

> “He survived the accident.”

「他在事故中生還。」

Survive emphasizes overcoming a threat.

Important distinction: **live vs exist**

live

usually applies to living beings or an active way of life.

exist

simply means be real/present.

> “Dinosaurs no longer exist.”

「恐龍已經不存在。」

Not:

> “Dinosaurs no longer live.”

unless talking about whether members are currently alive.

Important distinction: **live vs reside**

live

normal everyday word.

reside

formal/legal.

> “She lives in Canada.”

Everyday.

> “The applicant currently resides in Canada.”

Formal.

Both can mean 「居住」.

Important distinction: **live broadcast vs recorded broadcast**

live

= being transmitted while happening.

recorded

= captured earlier and played later.

> “The interview is live.”

「訪問正在現場直播。」

> “The interview was pre-recorded.”

「訪問是預先錄製的。」

Important distinction: **live music vs recorded music**

live music

performers are performing at the time.

recorded music

sound was recorded earlier and is being played back.

A venue can have:

> “live music every Friday”

= 每星期五都有現場音樂表演。

Important distinction: **live system vs test system**

Especially important in technology.

live / production system

= real system being used by actual users.

test system

= environment for experimenting/testing.

> “Don't make this change on the live system.”

「不要直接在正式運作中的系統上作這項修改。」

Important distinction: **living vs livelihood**

living

can mean the money someone earns:

> “make a living”

livelihood

means the activity/source from which that income comes.

> “Fishing is his livelihood.”

「捕魚是他的謀生方式。」

They overlap but are not identical.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- * **live — reside** = 居住
- * **live — be alive** = 活著／生存
- * **live for/to + time/age** = 活多久／活到幾歲
- * **live a + type of life** = 過某種生活
- * **live a dream/life** = 親身實現／經歷
- * **live up to** = 達到期待／不負名聲
- * **live — maintain life** = 維生／過活
- * **live — continue figuratively** = 流傳／延續
- * **live — broadcast** = 現場直播的
- * **live — performance** = 現場演出的
- * **live audience** = 現場觀眾
- * **live — technology** = 已正式啟用／運作中的
- * **live data** = 即時／真實運作資料
- * **live wire** = 帶電電線
- * **live ammunition** = 實彈
- * **live issue** = 當前仍重要／未解決的議題
- * **live animal/cell** = 活體／活細胞
- * **live coal/ember** = 仍在燃燒／帶火的
- * **living — biological** = 有生命的
- * **living — noun** = 生活
- * **a living** = 生計／收入
- * **living language/tradition** = 仍在使用和發展的

* **alive** = 活著的; 充滿活力的
 * **lively** = 活潑／生動／熱烈的
 * **livable/liveable** = 宜居／適合居住的
 * **livelihood** = 生計來源

And **life** is, of course, closely related—but we already curated **life** comprehensively, so under our duplicate rule I'm deliberately not regenerating it here.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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live — reside	把某個地方作為日常固定住所並在那裡生活
live — be alive	保持生命、繼續生存而沒有死亡
live for/to	生存某段時間／活到某個年齡
live a life	以某種方式度過自己的人生
live a dream/experience	親身實現、實踐或真正經歷某種人生／理想
live up to	實際表現達到某個期待、名聲、標準或承諾所建立的水平
live — subsist	依靠某種收入、資源或條件維持生活
live — figurative continuation	思想、傳統、記憶或作品仍然存在並持續產生影響
live — broadcast	事件發生的同時直接向觀眾播出、非預先錄製的
live — performance	表演者在觀眾面前即場演出，而非播放錄音／錄影的
live audience	真正身處現場觀看或參與的人
live — technology	已正式啟用並由真實使用者／正式系統使用的
live data	來自當前真實運作環境的即時資料
live — electricity	正在承載電流、可能造成觸電危險的
live — ammunition	真正具有發射／爆炸能力，而非訓練或假彈的
live issue	現時仍具現實重要性、正在討論或尚未解決的議題
live — biological adjective	仍具有生命活動、不是死亡的
live coal/ember	仍然發熱、燃燒或可能再次引燃的
living — organism	目前具有生命的; 現存的
living — lifestyle	日常生活及維持生活的方式／條件
a living	足以支付日常生活需要的收入／謀生所得
living language/tradition	目前仍有人實際使用、實踐並持續演變的
alive	仍然有生命; 引申為充滿活動、能量或生氣
lively	充滿活力、活動、興奮感; 亦可指內容生動有趣
livable/liveable	生活條件達到適合人合理／舒適居住的程度
livelihood	用來賺取收入、維持日常生活的工作或經濟來源

For your original sentence

> “A few weeks later, I bought the headphones, and they really **lived up to the hype**.”

The exact meaning is:

****lived up to the hype = 耳機實際使用後的表現真的達到了廣告、口碑和熱度先前建立的高期待****

So naturally:

> ****“They really lived up to the hype.”****

= ****「它們真的不負之前的好評和熱度。」****

or more explicitly:

> ****「它們的實際表現確實達到了之前宣傳所帶來的高期待。」****

And this family gives us one particularly important learner point:

> ****live (verb: 居住／生活)**** and ****live (adjective: 現場的／帶電的／即時的)**** are spelled identically but pronounced differently.